

Comments on EAC Audit Standards

The Draft covers a wide range of issues. I suggest adding the following:

Definition of ballot image audit

This method is used statewide in GA, MD, SC, and in some counties elsewhere. Each of the three states audits all contests this way, and only a few by RLA or hand count. This method does not rescan the paper ballots, so it differs from the term already in the document: “Automated independent ballot audit”, which “recounts all paper ballots through a different tabulation system.” That is used in FL, NH, VT.

Ballot Image Audit (BIA)	An audit which re-analyzes verified ballot images to check election results, without rescanning paper
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More options on independence

Both internal & external audits are valuable, just as they are for financial audits.

- **Authorization:** Audits should be ~~conducted at the direction of the chief election official at the state or local level, and~~ authorized in law or regulation where possible and should cover as many aspects and contests as possible.
- ...
- **Independence:** Auditors should maintain a degree of independence from the work being audited, and audit reports should be clear whether they were done by election officials or others ~~neither the audit process nor results should depend solely on the chief election official.~~

Standards for audit reports

Having standards for audit reports will enable future EAVS and Policy Surveys to collect basic standardized data. Audit reports should include, when applicable:

1. Dates when audit was conducted
2. Topic(s) covered by the audit
3. List of discrepancies audit found in any numbers or interpretations (usually small but not zero), and reasonable explanations
4. Extent of audit: whether all (contests, voters, sites, dates, etc.) were covered under each topic, or random, or selective
5. Audit limitations (e.g. not able to cover some parts of the topic) and risk of missing issues (e.g. RLA risk limit)
6. Audit methods
7. Who appointed auditors: which office managed each part of the audit and where the staff came from
8. How any contractor was selected
9. Size and mix of work teams (for hand counts, site visits, etc.)
10. Links to laws, rules, contracts, guidelines and any other backup about the audit
11. Links to election results
12. Link(s) to other website(s) with relevant information, including any videos of processing, copies of tally sheets, access logs, critical reports, etc.

Those standards enable transparency and future EAC survey questions such as:

- A. Length, topics and broad methods of audits done by local election offices, and by the state
- B. Use of contractor support
- C. Size and mix of teams

I hope these comments are helpful in advancing the document and the cause of audits.

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